b. You would have read the above article once, twice or more. While reading for the first time, you would have got a general idea of the text and repeated reading would have helped you comprehend it better. In this context have you heard of the terms Skimming and Scanning?

Skimming is the process of identifying quickly the main ideas of a given text.

⇒ Skim the words in bold-type, italics, digits or capitalised words.

⇒ Before reading the newspaper, one generally skims through in order to decide what to read.

Scanning is the process of reading quickly to get the specific information from a given text.

⇒ Searching for the meaning of a word from a dictionary or finding out the location in an advertisement is scanning.

Now, go back to the first paragraph of the given passage and skim it for general information and underline the main ideas. Also, scan the final paragraph and mention the uses of English language skills.

DO YOU KNOW?

The most commonly used letter in the alphabet is ' e'.

The least used letter in the alphabet is 'q'

The dot on top of the letter 'i' is called a title.

A new word is added to the English Dictionary every two hours officially.

'Swims' will be 'Swims' even when read upside down.

Language Study

a. Abbreviations and Acronyms

We come across many abbreviations while reading texts. Do you know that an **abbreviation** is a shortened or contracted form of a word or phrase? An **acronym** is a specific type of **abbreviation** formed from the first letters of a multi-word term, name, or phrase, with those letters pronounced together as one term.

For example:

ICU – Intensive Care Unit (Abbreviation)

VIRUS – Vital Information Resource Under Siege (Acronym)

Task: Expand the given abbreviations and acronyms found in the fields mentioned below.

MEDICINE

WBC	
CT	
MRI	
ECG	

COMPUTERS

VGA	
HTTP	
PDF	
JPEG	

HOSPITALITY

GPS	
GST	
VAT	
CCTV	

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